

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract taken from an article about the secrets to a long life:

Secrets to having a long life

Many people wish for longevity (i.e. having a long life) on their birthday. To uncover the secrets to long life, Professor Yang Zhimin, Vice-President of the Guangdong Province Hospital for Traditional Chinese Medicine, led a research team and interviewed 128 elderly people between 100–110 years old in Guangzhou. They discovered many common factors:

Factors

1. 80% are women;
2. 60% live with their spouses or children, emphasising the importance of family care and support;
3. 84% are non-smokers and 68% are non-drinkers;
4. Fresh fruits and vegetables are the most common parts of their daily diet, while fatty and preserved food is avoided;
5. 90% have three meals at regular times every day;
6. 63% sleep at least eight hours every day;
7. Doing housework and going on walks are their main sources of physical exercise; and
8. 55% hold a positive attitude and do not view themselves as being a burden to their families.

Based on the survey results, Yang summarised that having a long life requires observing four rules, namely, a proper diet, regular habits, exercise and a positive mindset.

Your teacher has assigned your group to give a short talk to the school during the school's Live Well Week about achieving long life. Discuss with your group what to include in your talk. You may want to talk about:

- which four of the eight factors to include in your talk and why
- which rule is the most important for achieving a long life
- activities that can be included in the Live Well Week
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you usually eat breakfast?
2. Do you usually sleep eight hours a day?
3. Do you eat three regular meals a day?
4. What other activities can elderly people do to live a longer life?
5. Why do you think women live longer than men?
6. Would you want to live to a hundred years old?
7. Do you think you would have the discipline to follow the four rules?
8. Why do some people not want to live a long life?

DO NOT TAKE AWAY